

Doomer Optimism Podcast – Professionalization & Distribution Plan
For Producer / Production Partner
Prepared by Ashley Fitzgerald, May 2026

1. Vision & Goals

We want to professionalize Doomer Optimism to the level of a polished, high-impact independent podcast. The goal is high-quality, reliable output that feels professional while staying true to our authentic, solutions-focused voice. We already have:

- An active YouTube channel (@doomeroptimism)
- A Substack (for written content and newsletter)
- Distribution across major podcast platforms (Apple, Spotify, etc.)

We will build on these rather than replace them. Key upgrades include consistent professional branding and graphics, broadcast-quality editing, full transcripts, companion articles, and short-form video clips for social amplification.

2. Annual Cadence (Moderate & Sustainable)

- 30–40 main episodes per year (roughly 2–3 episodes per month on average).
- This sets realistic expectations for quality and prevents burnout.
- Episodes will be released on a consistent schedule (e.g., every other Wednesday or a fixed day we agree on).

3. Per-Episode Deliverables

For every episode, please deliver the following (all with consistent Doomer Optimism branding and visual identity):

- Audio
 - Professionally edited, noise-reduced, EQ'd, with intro/outro music, chapter timestamps, and clean exports.
 - High broadcast quality.
- Video
 - Full long-form video version suitable for YouTube (multi-camera or clean talking-head style with B-roll where appropriate).
 - Edited for pacing, with graphics overlays, lower thirds, and chapter markers.
- Short-Form Video Clips
 - 3–5 short-form videos per episode (15–60 seconds each).
 - Pulled and edited directly from the long-form recording (highlight the most compelling, quotable, or visually engaging moments).
 - Optimized for social platforms (Instagram, Facebook, TikTok, Twitter/X): vertical 9:16 format, with captions, subtle branding/watermark, and on-screen text for silent viewing.

- Each clip should stand alone, drive curiosity, and include a clear call-to-action (e.g., “Watch the full episode — link in bio”).
 - Delivered as ready-to-post MP4 files.
- Graphics & Visuals
 - Custom episode thumbnail (YouTube-optimized).
 - Social media graphics (for posts promoting the full episode and the short clips).
 - Consistent podcast cover art / visual identity refreshed as needed.
- Written Content
 - Full transcript of the episode (cleaned and formatted).
 - Companion long-form article (1,500–2,500 words) expanding on key takeaways, quotes, resources, and practical action steps. Published on Substack.
- Animation (Occasional)
 - 1–2 short animated explainers or highlight reels per year (or per major theme) to illustrate complex ideas. Not required for every episode.
- Show Notes
 - Timestamps, links, guest bio, and resource list — published with the episode everywhere.
 - Include a clean, categorized bibliography of all sources referenced in the episode to feed into the website’s searchable research library.

All files should be delivered in a shared drive/folder with clear naming conventions (e.g., “Episode-XXX_Short1_Instagram.mp4”, “Episode-XXX_Transcript.docx”, “Episode-XXX_Companion-Article.docx”).

4. Platform Strategy & Workflow

We will use a hub-and-spoke model:

- Central Hub: DoomerOptimism.com (or the podcast section) — full archive, resources, and searchable research library.
- YouTube (@doomeroptimism) — primary home for full video episodes.
- Substack — written depth: companion article + transcript + show notes as the main post for each episode.
- Podcast Directories (Apple, Spotify, etc.) — full audio episodes with rich show notes.
- Social Media (IG, FB, TikTok, Twitter/X) — short-form clips (3–5 per episode) + graphics to drive traffic back to the full episode on YouTube/Substack. Clips will be the main amplification tool here.

Release Workflow (suggested):

1. Episode recorded → raw files to producer.
2. Producer delivers: edited long-form audio/video, 3–5 short-form clips, graphics, transcript, draft companion article, and categorized bibliography.
3. Ashley reviews/approves.

4. Publish simultaneously: YouTube video + Substack article + audio to all directories.
5. Social clips and promotion roll out immediately after (or staggered across platforms).

5. Branding & Overall Tone

- Consistent, hopeful-yet-realistic visual identity (warm earth tones, regenerative imagery, clean modern design).
- All graphics, thumbnails, short clips, and animations must match the refreshed branding.
- Tone: Clear-eyed realism about the Machine paired with practical, community-led hope.

6. Success Metrics

- Professional polish comparable to top-tier independent podcasts.
- Increased audience growth and engagement, especially via short-form social clips.
- Evergreen content (transcripts + articles + clips + research library) that ranks in search and builds a searchable library.
- Sustainable pace of 30–40 high-quality episodes per year.

This plan gives us a clear, repeatable system that elevates Doomer Optimism into a durable, respected platform. The addition of 3–5 short-form clips per episode will significantly boost discoverability and reach across social platforms.